Figure 1: Error message after `passwd` file is deleted

Figure 2: GRUB menu

Scene 3: `/etc/inittab` is deleted

We know that in Linux, `init` is the first process to be started and it starts all the other processes. The `/etc/inittab` file contains instructions for the `init` process and if it's missing, then no further process can be launched. On starting a system with no `inittab` file, it will show the following message:

```
'INIT:No inittab file found'
```

...and will ask you to enter a runlevel. When you do that, it again shows the message that no more processes are left in this runlevel.

Fixing this problem is not easy because being in the single user mode doesn't help in this case. Here, you need the Linux rescue environment to fix this problem. So set your first boot device to `CD` and boot with the RHEL5 CD. At the boot prompt, type 'Linux rescue' to enter the rescue environment.

Once you have entered into the rescue environment, your system will be mounted under `/mnt/sysimage`. Here, reinstall the package that provides the `/etc/inittab` file. The overall process is given below:

```
chroot /mnt/sysimage
rpm -q --whatprovides /etc/inittab
mkdir /a
mount /dev/hdc /a
```

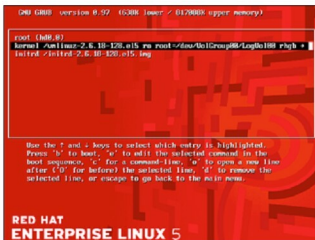


Figure 3: Edit kernel parameters



Figure 4: Enter into single user mode

Here `/dev/hdc` is the path of the CD. It may vary on your system, though.

```
rpm -Uvh --force /a/Server/updates/8.45.25-1.el5.i386.rpm
```

You can also hit the `Tab` key after `init` to auto complete the name.

Now you'll get your `/etc/inittab` file back. The same procedure can be applied to recover the `/etc/pam.d/login` file. In this case, you'll have to install the `util-linux` package. Once you are done with it, type `Exit` to leave the rescue environment, set your first boot device to hard disk and boot normally.

Scene 4: `/boot/grub/grub.conf` is deleted

This file is the configuration file of the GRUB boot loader. If it is deleted and you start your machine, you will see a GRUB prompt that indicates that `grub.conf` is missing and there is no further instruction for GRUB to carry on its operation.